A *mock* in testing is a substitute for a real component (e.g., a data provider or an object) that a singular function or method relies on. The mock imitates the behavior of the real component, but it doesn't have the actual functionality. When writing tests that need a mock, you normally have to set up the expectations for the component you're interacting with as part of your test.

On the other hand, a *stub* is a simplified version of a component that provides predetermined responses. It doesn't have the full component functionality but responds according to a predefined script or set of rules. When writing tests that need a stub, normally, the stub has already been created and has a preprogrammed response sitting outside your test.

From a consumer contract point of view, it's important to understand that you need mocks and not stubs, and that mocks are what tools such as Pact provide. A mock validates the behavior of your test, whereas a stub does not. When you write a consumer contract test, you follow this approach (see figure 4.1):

1. Initialize the setup of your mock provider.
2. Set the expectations that the consumer has against the mock provider.
3. Call the consumer against the mock provider. The mock provider validates the test, and, if successful, the contract is generated. If not successful, the test fails, and the contract isn't generated.